VoltGuard

VoltGuard™ Home Savings Guide

How to see it working on your meter, where a second unit goes, and the things in a South African home that quietly eat units.

2026 edition · contact@velarp.com

Written for South African homes

Thank you for your order. This short guide does three things. It shows you how to see VoltGuard™ working on your own meter, in a fair way. It tells you where to plug it in, and where a second unit does the most good. And it lists the things in an ordinary home that quietly eat units, so you can stop them without giving up hot water or a warm house.

Keep it on your phone. It takes ten minutes to read.

1. The first day

- Find a free plug point. The one nearest your DB board is a good first choice, but any free wall socket in the house works.
- Plug VoltGuard™ in. The green light comes on. That is all. No switch, no settings, no electrician.
- Leave it plugged in day and night. It has no moving parts and gives off no heat.
- Want to move it later? Just unplug it and plug it in somewhere else.

2. How to see it working on your meter

The bill total is a bad yardstick. It moves with the tariff, the season, a cold snap, visitors, and the fixed charges your municipality adds every month. Units per day is a fair yardstick. Here is the method.

If you are on prepaid

1. Every morning at the same time, write down the units left on the meter. A notebook on the fridge works. So does a note on your phone.
2. Do this for seven days before you plug VoltGuard™ in, if you can. If it is already plugged in, start today anyway.
3. Keep doing it for 30 days with VoltGuard™ plugged in.
4. Units used in a day = yesterday's reading minus today's reading. Add the units you bought on any day you topped up.

5. Compare the average units per day before and after. Compare like with like: the same season, the same people in the house, the geyser on the same hours.

If you are on a monthly account

1. Read the meter yourself on the first morning of the month and write the number down.
2. Read it again a month later. The difference is your real usage for the month, whatever the bill says.
3. Compare months in the same season. A July reading against a January reading tells you about winter, not about the device.

What the green light means

The light shows the unit is powered and working. It does not change colour or blink as it works. The proof is on the meter, not on the light.

3. Where a second unit does the most good

The article you read says it plainly: for homes under 70 m², one VoltGuard™ unit is enough. In bigger houses you can use several units to get the most out of your savings.

If you have a second unit, or are thinking about one, these are the places that make sense:

- The other end of the house. In a long house or a double storey, put one unit near the DB board and one near the bedrooms.
- A separate building on the same meter. A granny flat, a cottage, a workshop or a garage with its own freezer.
- Someone who needs it as much as you do. A parent in a retirement cottage, a neighbour, or the children's house. It plugs in the same way anywhere in South Africa.

One unit per plug point. It does not need its own circuit and it does not matter which socket in the room you use.

4. The things that never switch off

Most of the electricity a home pays for goes into things that run all day and all night, whether anyone is home or not. These are the ones worth looking at.

The fridge and the freezer

- Check the door seals. Close the door on a piece of paper. If the paper slides out easily, the seal is tired and the compressor runs more than it should.
- Leave a hand's width behind the fridge so the coils can breathe. Dust the coils once a season.
- A second freezer in the garage is often the biggest single user in the house. If it is half empty, fill the space with bottles of water, or switch it off and use one freezer.

The pool pump

- A pool pump does not need to run all day. In winter, four to six hours is usually enough. In summer, six to eight. A simple timer pays for itself quickly.
- Run it in the daytime if you are on a time-of-use tariff, or whenever your tariff is cheapest.

The TV box, the decoder and the chargers

- Decoders, TV boxes, game consoles and printers draw power on standby around the clock. Put them on a multiplug with a switch and switch it off at night.
- Phone and laptop chargers left in the wall draw a little all the time. Unplug them when nothing is charging.

The geyser

The geyser is the biggest user in most South African homes, and it is a plain heating coil: every unit it draws becomes hot water. That is why timers and

blankets on their own often disappoint people who expected the bill to halve. They help a little. These settings help the most:

- Set the thermostat to 55 to 60 degrees. Hotter than that is money down the drain and a scald risk.
- A geyser blanket and pipe insulation keep the heat in between showers, especially on the Highveld in winter.
- Shorter showers beat a timer. Ten minutes less in the shower every day is a real saving you can see on the meter.
- If you switch the geyser off when you go away, switch it on an hour before you need hot water, not the night before.

Lights

- Replace the last incandescent and halogen bulbs with LED. An LED uses roughly a tenth of the power for the same light and lasts years.
- Outside lights on a daylight sensor or a timer, so they are not burning at noon.

The kitchen

- Boil only the water you need. A full kettle for one cup is the commonest small waste in the house.
- Keep lids on pots. Use the microwave for reheating. A tumble dryer is one of the hungriest appliances in the house: a washing line costs nothing.

5. When the power comes back

After an outage, a trip or a storm, the power can come back with a surge. The things that die first are the fridge, the TV, the decoder, the router and anything with a circuit board.

- During an outage, switch off the geyser, the oven and the aircon at the DB board, and unplug the TV and the computer. Switch them back on a few minutes after the power returns.

- A surge-protected multiplug in front of the TV and the router is cheap insurance.
- Keep your meter number and your municipality's fault line on the fridge, so a problem is one call, not an evening of searching.

6. Reading your bill

- The tariff went up again in 2026. Eskom's increase was 8.76% from April, and most municipalities added about 9% from July. If your usage stayed the same, the bill still went up by that much.
- Most municipal bills carry fixed charges, a basic charge or a service fee, that you pay even if you used nothing. No device and no habit changes those. Look for them on the bill so you know what part of it is usage.
- Prepaid: the first units in a month are cheaper than the later ones on most municipal tariffs. Buying a smaller amount early in the month, and again later, costs the same as one big purchase. The units do not get cheaper by buying in bulk.
- If the bill is an estimate, not a reading, you can give your own reading to the municipality. An estimated bill that is too high is money you lend them for free.

7. Your guarantee and your questions

VoltGuard™ comes with a 60-day money-back guarantee, no questions asked. If you do not see a difference, one email and you get your full purchase price back. The same guarantee covers every unit in your parcel.

Your tracking number arrives by email within three working days of your order. Delivery is free anywhere in South Africa.

Questions? Write to contact@velarp.com. We answer within 24 hours, seven days a week.

Thank you for trusting us with your home.